

Creating a PIN

Windows 8 allows you to log in to the machine using a 4-digit PIN (reminds you of an ATM, eh?) as an alternate option. You can create a PIN in the same user management section within the PC settings app. The process is simple: click the 'Create PIN' button, enter a 4-digit pin twice and you'll be able to use it the next time you need to log in to Windows. Although too small a feature, when you opt to sign in with a PIN, Windows doesn't require you to press [Enter]. The moment you enter the 4th digit in the correct sequence, you'll be signed in.

Creating a picture password

This feature seems to be inspired by the pattern locking feature in Android. Windows 8 allows you to draw a series of three gestures where each gesture is a circle, straight line or a tap. You can create a picture password from the same user management screen in the PC settings. Once there, click on the 'Create picture password' button.

You'll be asked to enter your existing password. Next, Windows 8 would visually show you a sample of how to draw a line or a circle while giving an option to choose the picture to be used for picture password. Click on 'Choose picture' button and it would let you swipe through the picture gallery (the 'pictures' library in File Explorer). Though you can choose a picture from other libraries as well, browsing the disk is not allowed – you must add the picture to a library before you could use it for picture password. After choosing the picture, you're allowed to drag and reposition the picture well enough so that the area you're interested in is visible. Then, draw the gestures on the picture, twice. Once confirmed, the gestures are saved and along with the picture itself form the 'picture password'.

Family Safety in Windows 8

Much like in Windows 7, the Family Safety feature allows an administrator (the parent) to control the resources accessible to another account (child account). Family Safety can be enabled for a user under **Control Panel > User Accounts and Family Safety > Family Safety**. This facility enables the parent to restrict PC usage on four parameters:

1. **Time Usage:** The parent can determine how long a child can spend on the PC on weekdays and weekends or can set time periods for each day when the child can't access the computers – useful to drive home the point of "no late night gaming".